WEB PROGRAMMING – COURSE PROJECT

Project description

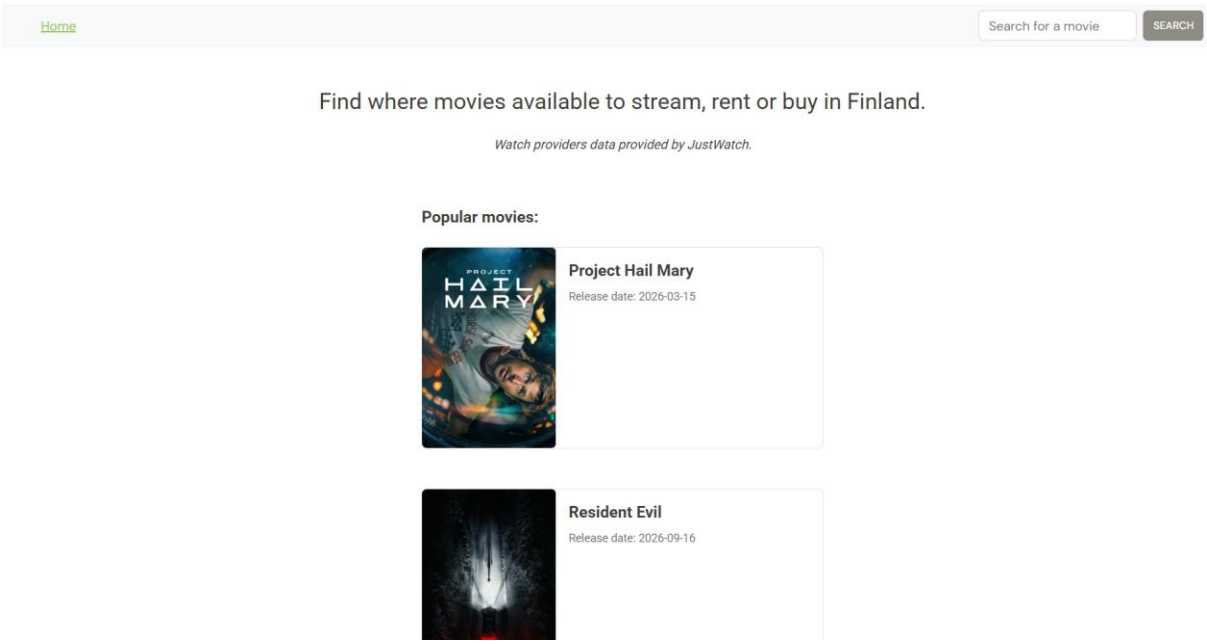
Most streaming services like Netflix annoyingly hide what titles they have for streaming behind the subscription meaning you can't browse their catalogue without purchasing the subscription. There are other Apps like JustWatch that show what different streaming services have available, but I wanted to try to create my own and to see what you could do with free APIs.

The app uses TMBD API to fetch popular movies, to search for movies and for detailed info of the movies, images and where they are available to stream, rent or buy in Finland. For styling I used Bootstrap, Bootswatch for Bootstrap themes and Google Fonts for styling the fonts.

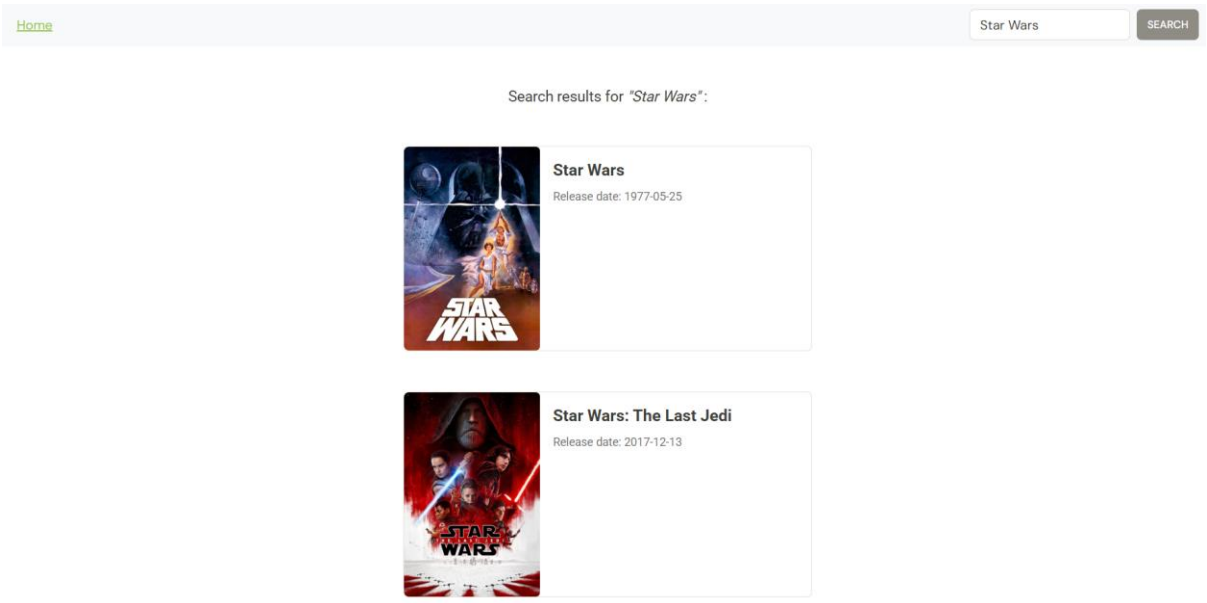
GitHub: https://github.com/MrGumbert/final-project.git

GitHub Pages: https://mrgumbert.github.io/final-project/

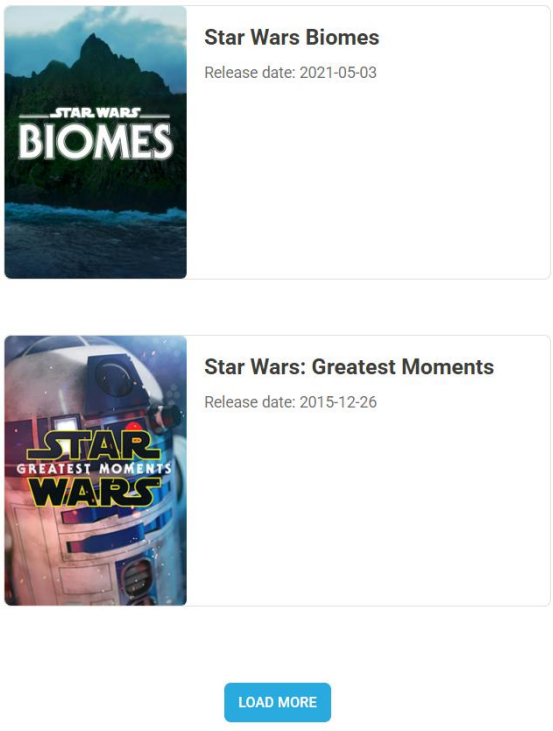
Home page (lists 20 most popular titles. Click movie title or the poster for details on the movie):



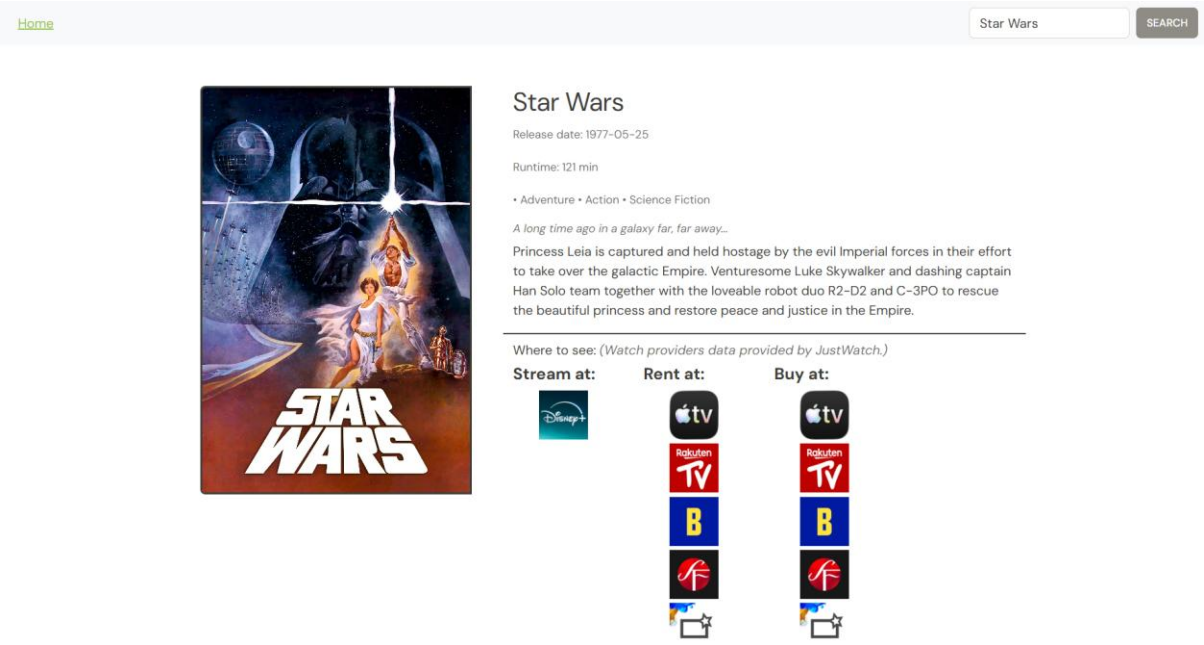
Search results page (type search word to the top right):



Bottom of Search results screen, where you can load more results, if there are:



Details page (Some basic info on the movie and where it's available to stream, rent, or buy. The page will also tell, if it's not available to stream, rent or buy):



Usage of AI:

I asked Claude for conceptual help, but I don't use Claude code in my editor, so I didn't ask it to write the code for me. For example, when I needed to find a way to automatically navigate to another page, I asked Claude for conceptual help and when I ran into the problem of not being able to fetch new results when typing a new search word. I didn't understand what the problem was. I used Claude for debugging the problem.

I hadn't used GitHub pages before to publish a project, so I had to do some research and ask Claude for guidance when I ran into problems creating the deploy.yaml file and adding configurations to the vite.config.js file.

Reflection:

I quickly settled on the TMDB API. I find it to be more comprehensive than some other free movie APIs. It's also free and it also has an endpoint to fetch the watch providers info.

From the start, it was clear that I should have a component for the movie cards, which I could reuse. At first, I had all the information about the movie in that card, but they were rather big with lots of information. I made them rather plain and moved the information to the Details pages. This also meant moving the details fetch using the API to the Details page, because that endpoint returns more info on the movie than the popular movies endpoint or the search endpoint. I also moved the fetching of the provider's information on a movie to the Details page. I fetched that info, for example at the same time when I fetched for the searches of movies but realized that there was no reason for that since it was only needed on the Details page, so I moved the availability fetch there.

Quite late, I realized that the search API endpoint might return multiple pages of results, but you can only fetch one page at a time. It was rather easy to set up a button and a logic to trigger a new fetch with an incremented page number, but then I ran into problem that when you searched for a movie and while being on the search results page, if you ran another search with a new movie title, the fetch wouldn't fire up.

If I had more time, I would maybe find a way to add direct links to the providers page for a movie like on the TMDB page. A login system would also be useful. Then I would be able to build a watchlist sort of system where users could add movies they are interested in. You could also add a feature where you list how many of them are available in each streaming service.